has grown as the challenge to existing institutions has gained weight. Even when outward violence has been toned down, it has taken subtler and more dangerous forms. Neither the growth of reason nor of the religious outlook nor morality have checked in any way this tendency to violence. Individuals have progressed and gone up in the human scale, and probably there are far more of these higher-type individuals (the highest type excepted) in the world to-day than at any previous period of history; society as a whole has progressed, and to a very small extent begun to attempt the control of the primitive and barbarian instincts. But on the whole groups and communities have not improved greatly. The individual in becoming more civilised has passed on many of his primitive passions and vices to the community, and as violence always attracts the morally second-rate, the leaders of these communities are seldom their best men and women.

But even if we assume that the worst forms of violence will be gradually removed from the State, it is impossible to ignore the fact that both government and social life necessitate some coercion. Social life necessitates some form of government, and the men so placed in authority must curb and prevent all individual or group tendencies which are inherently selfish and likely to injure society. Usually they go much further than necessary, for power corrupts and degrades. So that however much those rulers may love liberty and hate coercion, they will have to exercise coercion on recalcitrant individuals, till such time when every human being in that State is perfect, wholly unselfish, and devoted to the common good. The rulers of that State will also have to exercise coercion on outside groups who make predatory attacks, that is to say they will have to defend themselves, meeting force with force. The necessity for this will only disappear when there is only a single World-State.

If force and coercion are thus necessary both for external defence and internal cohesion, where is one to draw the line? Once this fateful concession is made of ethics to politics, Reinhold Neibuhr points out,[1] and coercion is accepted as a necessary instrument of social cohesion, it is not possible to make absolute distinctions between non-violent and violent types of coercion, or between the coercion used by governments and that used by revolutionaries.

I do not know for certain, but I imagine that Gandhiji will admit that in this imperfect world a national State will have to

[1] In *Moral Man and Immoral Society.*